

In comparison, the 1.5 TB version was available for just Rs. 6,500. It made excellent sense. For people who have lots of games and movies to store, this is something to think about. For those who want great value for money, the 1 TB Seagate makes equally good sense. In fact, two of these 1 TB drives would be some Rs. 3,500 cheaper than the 2 TB drive. Western Digital's drives were also very similarly priced with small differences of some Rs. 300 to Rs. 400.

That's not all people are looking for. People with just space requirements will be pleased by the Barracuda 7200.12 and Caviar Green series of drives from Seagate and WD respectively. The people who need performance aren't that simple to please I've learnt. There are always those who need the best performance they can

get, from every component in their system and this includes hard drives. For them, my advice is simple – get a WD Velociraptor. We've seen it in the test centre, and it's fast, really fast! Now if you can't afford it, WD's Black series of drives are the ones to go for. Don't be fooled when the shopkeeper tries to sell you a Green edition drive instead of a Black. There are major performance differences and you'll see them when you get system up and running. If you're looking for quiet, cool running single-platter drives, look no further than the Seagate Barracuda 7200.12 500 GB.

SSDs are getting cheaper. Intel's X25-M 80 GB SSD is now down to a slightly more affordable Rs. 16,000 and I was able to find it in a few shops. In the US, it's still a lot cheaper. I'm not so happy with its performance – in places, it shines but in others, it fails to keep up with the traditional motor powered counterparts. Reliability might be an issue as well but that's something that's hard to say right now.

Now, not everyone wants high-performance drives. Some, I'm sure, are looking for large capacity drives that sit outside your system. They use USB, Firewire or eSATA to transfer data from itself to the computer. So with such large capacity external drives, look for drives with eSATA. They offer much higher performance like internal drives. The advantage here



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